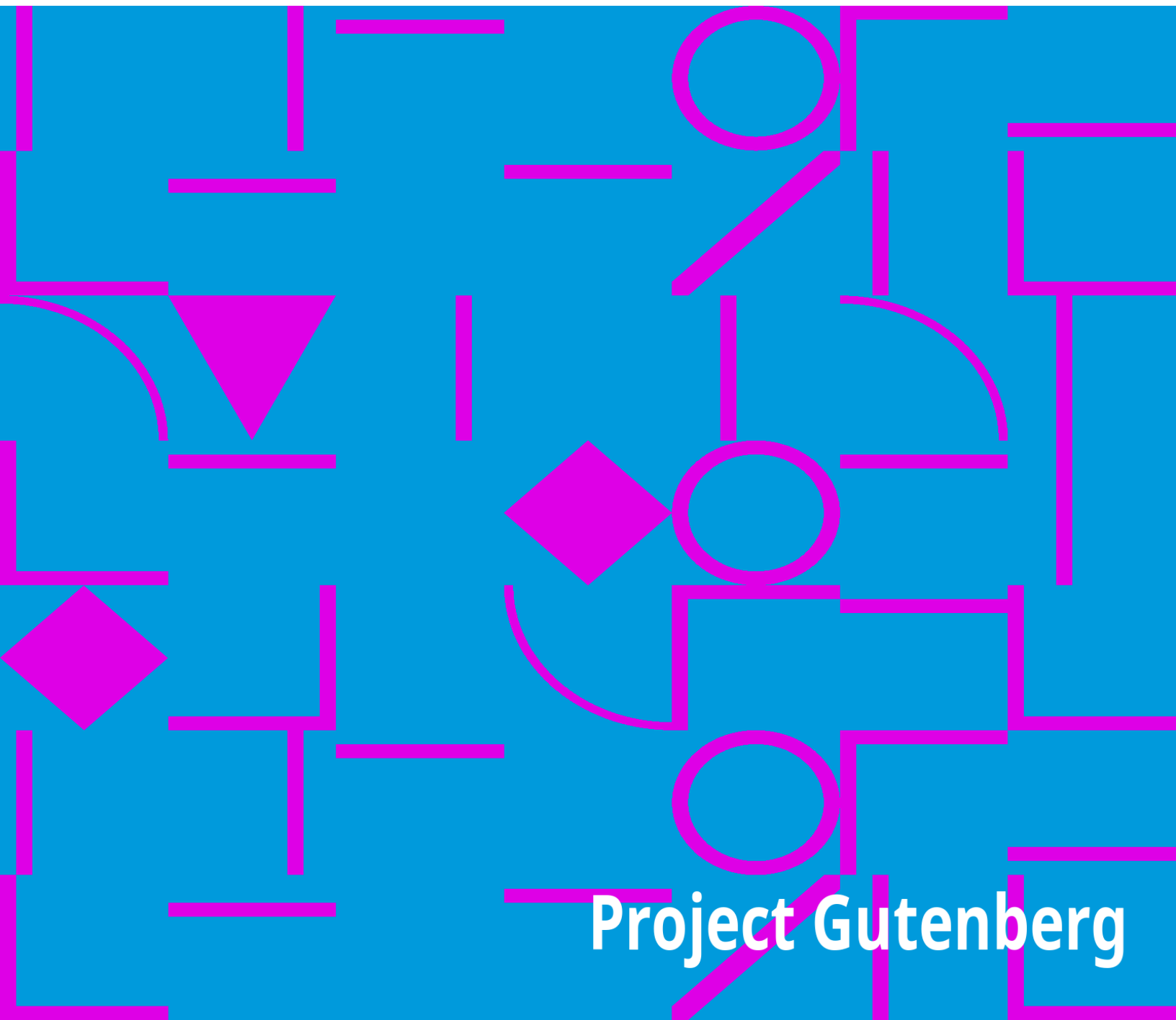


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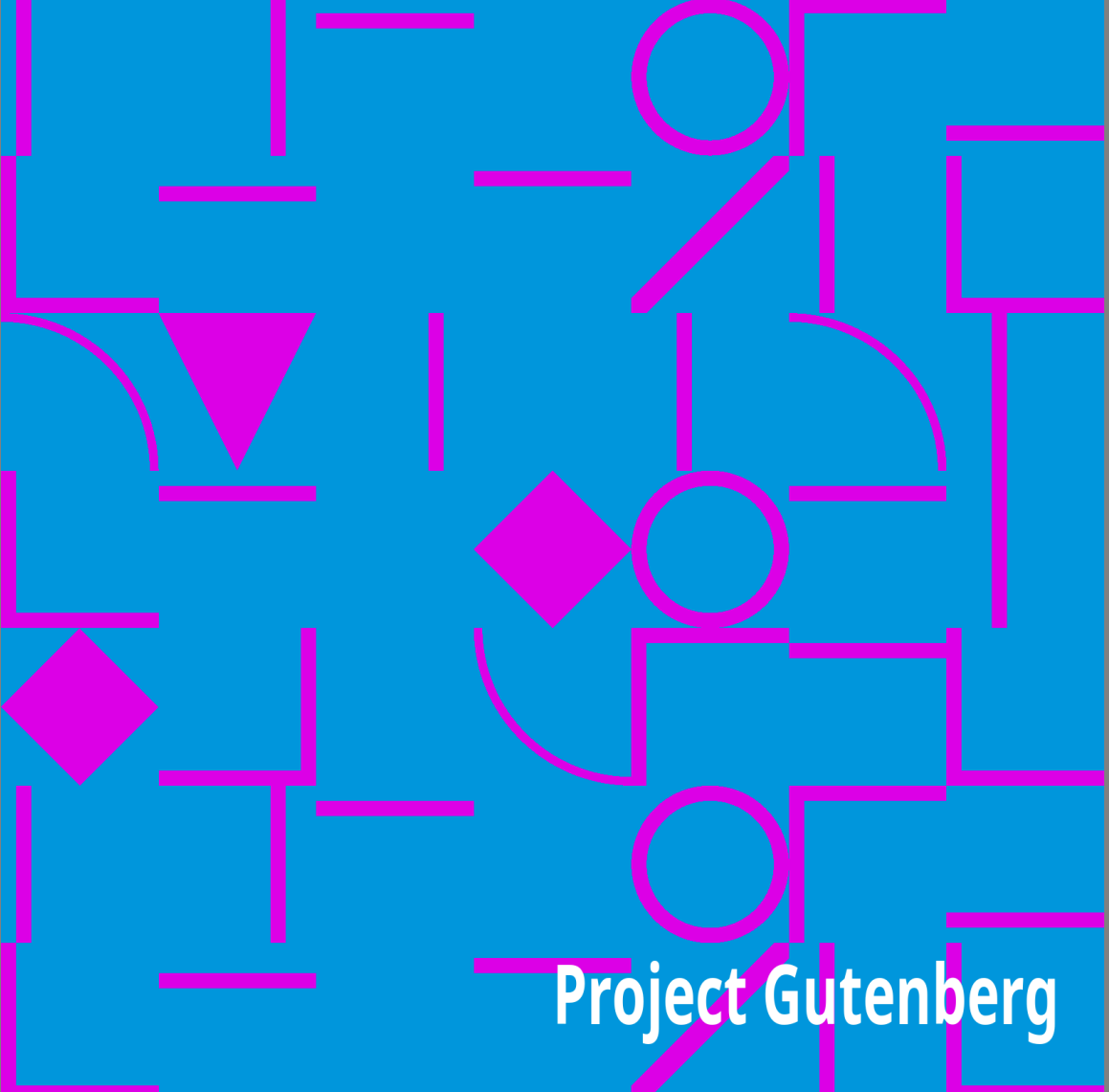
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**Book 29 Joel 001:001 The Word of
Yahweh that came to Joel, the son
of Pethuel. 001:002 Hear this, you
elders, And listen, all you
inhabitants of the land. Has this
ever happened in your days, or in
the days of your fathers? 001:003
Tell your children about it, and
have your children tell their
children, and their children,
another generation. 001:004 What
the swarming locust has left, the**

great locust has eaten. What the
great locust has left, the
grasshopper has eaten. What the
grasshopper has left, the caterpillar
has eaten. 001:005 Wake up, you
drunkards, and weep! Wail, all you
drinkers of wine, because of the
sweet wine; for it is cut off from
your mouth. 001:006 For a nation
has come up on my land, strong,
and without number. His teeth are
the teeth of a lion, and he has the
fangs of a lioness. 001:007 He has
laid my vine waste, and stripped
my fig tree. He has stripped its
bark, and thrown it away. Its
branches are made white. 001:008
Mourn like a virgin dressed in

sackcloth for the husband of her youth! 001:009 The meal offering and the drink offering are cut off from Yahweh's house. The priests, Yahweh's ministers, mourn.

001:010 The field is laid waste. The land mourns, for the grain is destroyed, The new wine has dried up, and the oil languishes. 001:011 Be confounded, you farmers! Wail, you vineyard keepers; for the wheat and for the barley; for the harvest of the field has perished.

001:012 The vine has dried up, and the fig tree withered; the pomegranate tree, the palm tree also, and the apple tree, even all of the trees of the field are withered;

**for joy has withered away from the
sons of men. 001:013 Put on
sackcloth and mourn, you priests!
Wail, you ministers of the altar.
Come, lie all night in sackcloth, you
ministers of my God, for the meal
offering and the drink offering are
withheld from your God's house.
001:014 Sanctify a fast. Call a
solemn assembly. Gather the elders,
and all the inhabitants of the land,
to the house of Yahweh, your God,
and cry to Yahweh. 001:015 Alas
for the day! For the day of Yahweh
is at hand, and it will come as
destruction from the Almighty.
001:016 Isn't the food cut off before
our eyes; joy and gladness from the**

house of our God? 001:017 The seeds rot under their clods. The granaries are laid desolate. The barns are broken down, for the grain has withered. 001:018 How the animals groan! The herds of livestock are perplexed, because they have no pasture. Yes, the flocks of sheep are made desolate. 001:019 Yahweh, I cry to you, For the fire has devoured the pastures of the wilderness, and the flame has burned all the trees of the field. 001:020 Yes, the animals of the field pant to you, for the water brooks have dried up, And the fire has devoured the pastures of the wilderness. 002:001 Blow the

trumpet in Zion, and sound an alarm in my holy mountain! Let all the inhabitants of the land tremble, for the day of Yahweh comes, for it is close at hand: 002:002 A day of darkness and gloominess, a day of clouds and thick darkness. As the dawn spreading on the mountains, a great and strong people; there has never been the like, neither will there be any more after them, even to the years of many generations. 002:003 A fire devours before them, and behind them, a flame burns. The land is as the garden of Eden before them, and behind them, a desolate wilderness. Yes, and no one has escaped them. 002:004 The

**appearance of them is as the
appearance of horses, and as
horsemen, so do they run. 002:005
Like the noise of chariots on the
tops of the mountains do they leap,
like the noise of a flame of fire that
devours the stubble, as a strong
people set in battle array. 002:006
At their presence the peoples are in
anguish. All faces have grown pale.
002:007 They run like mighty men.
They climb the wall like warriors.
They each march in his line, and
they don't swerve off course.
002:008 Neither does one jostle
another; they march everyone in
his path, and they burst through
the defenses, and don't break**

ranks. 002:009 They rush on the city. They run on the wall. They climb up into the houses. They enter in at the windows like thieves. 002:010 The earth quakes before them. The heavens tremble. The sun and the moon are darkened, and the stars withdraw their shining. 002:011 Yahweh thunders his voice before his army; for his forces are very great; for he is strong who obeys his command; for the day of Yahweh is great and very awesome, and who can endure it? 002:012 "Yet even now," says Yahweh, "turn to me with all your heart, and with fasting, and with weeping, and with mourning."

002:013 Tear your heart, and not your garments, and turn to Yahweh, your God; for he is gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness, and relents from sending calamity. 002:014 Who knows? He may turn and relent, and leave a blessing behind him, even a meal offering and a drink offering to Yahweh, your God. 002:015 Blow the trumpet in Zion! Sanctify a fast. Call a solemn assembly. 002:016 Gather the people. Sanctify the assembly. Assemble the elders. Gather the children, and those who suck the breasts. Let the bridegroom go forth from his

room, and the bride out of her chamber. 002:017 Let the priests, the ministers of Yahweh, weep between the porch and the altar, and let them say, "Spare your people, Yahweh, and don't give your heritage to reproach, that the nations should rule over them. Why should they say among the peoples, 'Where is their God?'" 002:018 Then Yahweh was jealous for his land, And had pity on his people. 002:019 Yahweh answered his people, "Behold, I will send you grain, new wine, and oil, and you will be satisfied with them; and I will no more make you a reproach among the nations. 002:020 But I

will remove the northern army far away from you, and will drive it into a barren and desolate land, its front into the eastern sea, and its back into the western sea; and its stench will come up, and its bad smell will rise." Surely he has done great things. 002:021 Land, don't be afraid. Be glad and rejoice, for Yahweh has done great things. 002:022 Don't be afraid, you animals of the field; for the pastures of the wilderness spring up, for the tree bears its fruit. The fig tree and the vine yield their strength. 002:023 "Be glad then, you children of Zion, and rejoice in Yahweh, your God; for he gives you

**the former rain in just measure,
and he causes the rain to come
down for you, the former rain and
the latter rain, as before. 002:024
The threshing floors will be full of
wheat, and the vats will overflow
with new wine and oil. 002:025 I
will restore to you the years that
the swarming locust has eaten, the
great locust, the grasshopper, and
the caterpillar, my great army,
which I sent among you. 002:026
You will have plenty to eat, and be
satisfied, and will praise the name
of Yahweh, your God, who has
dealt wondrously with you; and my
people will never again be
disappointed. 002:027 You will**

know that I am in the midst of Israel, and that I am Yahweh, your God, and there is no one else; and my people will never again be disappointed. 002:028 "It will happen afterward, that I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh; and your sons and your daughters will prophesy. Your old men will dream dreams. Your young men will see visions. 002:029 And also on the servants and on the handmaids in those days, I will pour out my Spirit. 002:030 I will show wonders in the heavens and in the earth: blood, fire, and pillars of smoke. 002:031 The sun will be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood,

**before the great and terrible day of
Yahweh comes. 002:032 It will
happen that whoever will call on
the name of Yahweh shall be saved;
for in Mount Zion and in
Jerusalem there will be those who
escape, as Yahweh has said, and
among the remnant, those whom
Yahweh calls. 003:001 "For,
behold, in those days, and in that
time, when I restore the fortunes of
Judah and Jerusalem, 003:002 I
will gather all nations, and will
bring them down into the valley of
Jehoshaphat; and I will execute
judgment on them there for my
people, and for my heritage, Israel,
whom they have scattered among**

**the nations. They have divided my
land, 003:003 and have cast lots for
my people, and have given a boy
for a prostitute, and sold a girl for
wine, that they may drink. 003:004
"Yes, and what are you to me, Tyre,
and Sidon, and all the regions of
Philistia? Will you repay me? And
if you repay me, I will swiftly and
speedily return your repayment on
your own head. 003:005 Because
you have taken my silver and my
gold, and have carried my finest
treasures into your temples,
003:006 and have sold the children
of Judah and the children of
Jerusalem to the sons of the
Greeks, that you may remove them**

**far from their border. 003:007
Behold, I will stir them up out of
the place where you have sold
them, and will return your
repayment on your own head;
003:008 and I will sell your sons
and your daughters into the hands
of the children of Judah, and they
will sell them to the men of Sheba,
to a faraway nation, for Yahweh
has spoken it." 003:009 Proclaim
this among the nations: "Prepare
for war! Stir up the mighty men.
Let all the warriors draw near. Let
them come up. 003:010 Beat your
plowshares into swords, and your
pruning hooks into spears. Let the
weak say, 'I am strong.' 003:011**

**Hurry and come, all you
surrounding nations, and gather
yourselves together." Cause your
mighty ones to come down there,
Yahweh. 003:012 "Let the nations
arouse themselves, and come up to
the valley of Jehoshaphat; for there
will I sit to judge all the
surrounding nations. 003:013 Put
in the sickle; for the harvest is ripe.
Come, tread, for the winepress is
full, the vats overflow, for their
wickedness is great." 003:014
Multitudes, multitudes in the valley
of decision! For the day of Yahweh
is near, in the valley of decision.
003:015 The sun and the moon are
darkened, and the stars withdraw**

their shining. 003:016 Yahweh will roar from Zion, and thunder from Jerusalem; and the heavens and the earth will shake; but Yahweh will be a refuge to his people, and a stronghold to the children of Israel. 003:017 "So you will know that I am Yahweh, your God, dwelling in Zion, my holy mountain. Then Jerusalem will be holy, and no strangers will pass through her any more. 003:018 It will happen in that day, that the mountains will drop down sweet wine, the hills will flow with milk, all the brooks of Judah will flow with waters, and a fountain will come forth from the house of Yahweh, and will water

the valley of Shittim. 003:019 Egypt will be a desolation, and Edom will be a desolate wilderness, for the violence done to the children of Judah, because they have shed innocent blood in their land.

003:020 But Judah will be inhabited forever, and Jerusalem from generation to generation.

003:021 I will cleanse their blood, that I have not cleansed: for Yahweh dwells in Zion."

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